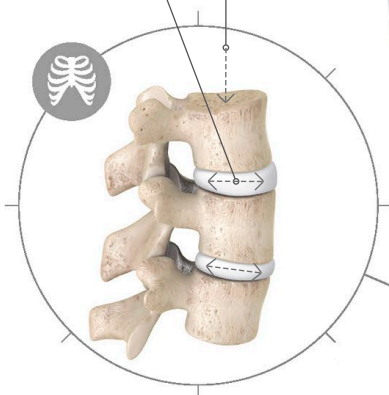


» CLOSER LOOK

In Accomplished pose, your intervertebral disks are stacked on top of each other, creating the natural curves of the neutral spine. As you breathe, your ribcage expands and releases efficiently, which is facilitated by sitting tall with good posture.

Cervical extensor muscles work to lengthen spine

Intervertebral disk
Vertebrae stack vertically

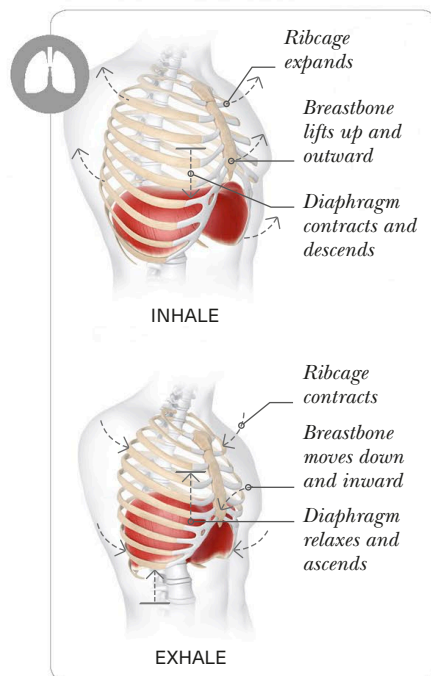


Disk stacking

When your spine is in its natural curvature—in a “neutral” position (see p.14)—your vertebrae are stacked and the gravitational load on your intervertebral disks is evenly distributed. Your disks are made of squishy fibrocartilage, allowing your spine to move dynamically.

Hip joint is rotated outward

LATERAL VIEW



Ribcage movement

As you inhale, your breastbone lifts while your ribcage expands in all directions and the diaphragm descends. As you exhale, your breastbone and ribs return down and inward; the diaphragm ascends to push out carbon dioxide. Allow this movement as you breathe.